

under the term WaveLan with speeds of 1-2 Mbit/s. Vic Hayes is known as the 'father of Wi-Fi' as he was actively involved in the design of standards such as IEEE 802.11b and 802.11a. IEEE is the Institute for Electrical and Electronics Engineers. It is a global non-profit professional organisation which, apart from publishing research work, fostering innovation and educational activities, also establishes

The Wi-Fi Alliance owns the trademark for Wi-Fi

international standards for electrical and electronic technology. The IEEE 802.11 is a set of standards which sets rules and protocol for wireless local area network communication in the 2.4, 3.6 and 5.0 GHz frequency bands.

The original patents for the Wi-Fi technology were filed in 1996 and are held by CSIRO, a research body in Australia. However, it gave way to several legal battles over non-payment of royalties between the research organisation and other major IT corporations. A settlement was reached in 2009, but the resolution was not revealed to the public. The Wireless Alliance is a body of several companies. It promotes standards aimed at improving the inter-operability of wireless LAN products based on the IEEE 802.11 standards, much like the Bluetooth Special Interest Group. The term Wi-Fi was first commercially used in August 1999 by the Wireless Alliance as it was considered more cool and catchy than the more technical IEEE 802.11b Direct Sequence. The term suggests Wireless Fidelity, in comparison with audio recording term High Fidelity, or Hi-Fi, as an indication of quality. Though the term Wireless Fidelity has been used in an informal way, the actual term Wi-Fi does not actually mean much. A look at the Yin-Yang logo for the Wi-Fi group also suggests the stress they lay on interoperability. The Alliance has however downplayed the link to Hi-Fi and now focuses on it being "a standard for wireless fidelity" and really just another brand name.

Wi-Fi Alliance: the Wi-Fi Alliance is a trade group that has the rights to the trademark Wi-Fi. Formed in 1999 in order to maintain compliance with IEEE 802.11 standards, the Wi-Fi Alliance monitors, tests and attests product and specification compliance to the IEEE standards for all electronic products